

DECODING YOU!

Can we really ever understand what makes you... you? Will we ever understand consciousness? Some certainly seem to think so...

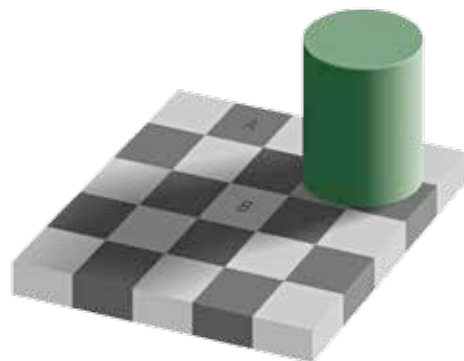
Ronak Gupta and Agent001 | feedback@digit.in

For many people, a discussion about consciousness immediately exits the realm of scientific discovery. This is because some scientists believe that we may never be able to understand the nature of consciousness. With so many smart people proven wrong when they make a claim about what humanity will never accomplish (or what amount of memory should be enough), you'd think people would hesitate to make such claims... yet here we are.

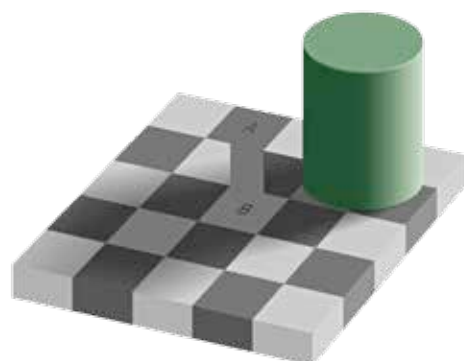
Why do we care about understanding consciousness? Because if we're addicted to, say, tech, as we claim, then it's obviously appealing to us on some baser level, but without understanding ourselves, how can we ever expect to learn why we love the things we love? In fact, can we ever truly understand ourselves? This cover story will first dig into showing you theories about what consciousness might be, in order to raise your level of...err...consciousness! Then we're going to look at why we're addicted to technology, and also explore ideas about how we could be getting suckered into liking stuff – you're going to love the psychological mind games we're capable of playing on one another!

Back to the theory of consciousness: the main objection people have against being able to understand it is that you cannot really use something to understand itself. Logic would dictate that a hammer cannot use itself to understand itself. (Assuming of course hammers could understand anything at all). To many of us, our ability to think, to be logical, to observe,

to exist itself... it's all a part of what we call consciousness. However, to others, just an ability of an organism to be able to sense its own existence is consciousness. How can we ever explain it, if we can't even agree on a definition?



Adelson's checkerboard shows a point A and B, and B looks far lighter than A, when in fact the two checks are identically coloured. Stop believing your eyes!



More clearly visible here with a grey line of the same colour drawn to connect them